AI EXPLAINED SIMPLY

10 Gemini Features + 10 Prompts (checked 3 Nov 2026)

Every feature below was checked on Google's own help pages and blog on 3 November 2026. Plans, countries and account types differ: check your own app. Google does not publish how much time these features save.

1. Upload files

Up to 10 files per prompt. Most files up to 100 MB, video up to 2 GB. Video: 5 minutes by default, 1 hour on Google AI Pro/Ultra. Audio: 10 minutes by default, 3 hours on those plans.

- `Summarize this in 10 bullet points. Then list every deadline, name and number I must remember.`
- `Make a chart from this spreadsheet: total by month.`

2. Deep Research

Add Files > Deep Research > edit the plan > Start research. Usually 5 to 10 minutes. Sources: web, Gmail, Drive, uploaded files, notebooks. Export to Google Docs.

- `Research how remote teams run weekly planning meetings. Compare 4 methods. Give me a table of pros and cons, with sources.`

3. Audio Overviews

Upload a file, then ask for an Audio Overview. Usually 3 to 5 minutes. Check key numbers against the original.

- `Create an Audio Overview of this document for someone who has never read it.`

4. Canvas

Add Files > Canvas. Docs, apps, slides, code. Export to Docs, Slides/PDF, Colab. A shared app link can be opened and edited by anyone with it.

- `Turn these meeting notes into a 6-slide deck for my manager. One idea per slide.`

5. Guided Learning

Questions first, answers later. Built with LearnLM. Link from Google's announcement: https://g.co/gemini/guidedlearning

- `Teach me how photosynthesis works. Ask me one question at a time and don't give the answer until I try.`

6. Schedules

Up to 10 active schedules. Keep Activity must be on. Answers are prepared in the hour before delivery: not for live prices.

- `Every weekday at 7 AM, give me a 5-bullet summary of the news in my industry, with one link per bullet.`

7. Gemini Live (phone)

Voice, camera, screen sharing, Guided Vision. Uses Calendar, Keep, Tasks. Not in the web app.

- Say: `What should I tidy first? Then add the first job to my Tasks.`

8. Connected apps (Personal Intelligence)

Personal accounts of adults, Keep Activity on, not work or school accounts, rolling out by country. You choose which apps to connect.

- `Find the email with my flight confirmation and tell me the check-in time.`

9. Notebooks

Notebook audio formats: Deep Dive, The Brief (one speaker, under 2 minutes), The Critique, The Debate.

- Custom prompt: `Focus on the three weakest arguments in my essay.`

10. Skills (replacing Gems)

Personal accounts (18+): Gems read-only 17 Nov 2026, removed 17 Dec 2026. Download Gem files and copy each Gem's name, description and instructions before then. Business: March 2027. Education: June 2027. Skills do not work yet with Canvas, Deep Research or Guided Learning.

- `Create a skill called Weekly Report. I'll paste raw notes. You return 3 sections: Done, Blocked, Next.`

Sources

- Gems to skills: https://support.google.com/gemini/answer/18560919
- Deep Research: https://support.google.com/gemini/answer/15719111
- Canvas: https://support.google.com/gemini/answer/16047321
- Audio Overviews: https://support.google.com/gemini/answer/16047373
- Gemini Notebook audio formats: https://support.google.com/gemininotebook/answer/16212820
- Schedules: https://support.google.com/gemini/answer/16316416
- Gemini Live: https://support.google.com/gemini/answer/15274899
- File uploads: https://support.google.com/gemini/answer/14903178
- Connect your Google apps: https://support.google.com/gemini/answer/16598406
- Guided Learning: https://blog.google/outreach-initiatives/education/guided-learning/

- Gemini Drop, April 2026: https://blog.google/innovation-and-ai/products/gemini-app/gemini-drop-april-2026/

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